College football picks (10.17.2026)

Engine (official) and framework side by side. All times Phoenix.

Kickoff	Game	Engine (official)	Framework	Framework score	
Sat 10.17.2026 9:00 AM	Ball State at Bowling Green	Ball State 50%	Bowling Green 66%	Bowling Green 29 - Ball State 23	**Split**
Sat 10.17.2026 9:00 AM	Charleston Southern at Clemson	No pick (both): not enough play-by-play this season: Charleston Southern			
Sat 10.17.2026 9:00 AM	Cincinnati at West Virginia	Cincinnati 51%	Cincinnati 56%	Cincinnati 33 - West Virginia 31	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 9:00 AM	Florida at Texas	No pick (both): Aaron Philo (shoulder) status in question, limited in practice all week; Tramell Jones would make his first start			
Sat 10.17.2026 9:00 AM	Florida Atlantic at Army	Army 63%	Florida Atlantic 51%	Florida Atlantic 33 - Army 32	**Split**
Sat 10.17.2026 9:00 AM	Georgia State at James Madison	**James Madison 70%**	Georgia State 56%	Georgia State 30 - James Madison 27	**Split**
Sat 10.17.2026 9:00 AM	Kansas at Kansas State	Kansas 52%	Kansas State 63%	Kansas State 33 - Kansas 27	**Split**
Sat 10.17.2026 9:00 AM	Mississippi State at LSU	No pick (both): Kamario Taylor (foot) questionable, decision not announced; Parker Puckett would start			
Sat 10.17.2026 9:00 AM	Northwestern at Michigan State	**Northwestern 71%**	**Northwestern 85%**	Northwestern 38 - Michigan State 21	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 9:00 AM	Ohio State at Indiana	Indiana 51%	Indiana 64%	Indiana 33 - Ohio State 27	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 9:00 AM	Pittsburgh at Boston College	No pick (both): Mason Heintschel (torn ACL) out for the season; Holden Geriner makes his 2nd start			
Sat 10.17.2026 9:00 AM	Virginia at SMU	**SMU 75%**	SMU 66%	SMU 32 - Virginia 25	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 9:30 AM	Rutgers at Maryland	No pick (both): Dylan Lonergan (head injury Oct 3 vs Indiana) status unconfirmed after the bye; AJ Surace would start			
Sat 10.17.2026 10:00 AM	Charlotte at Temple	No pick (both): QB changed last game (Conner Harrell started; Cole Gonzales started the first 5); starter vs Temple not announced			
Sat 10.17.2026 10:00 AM	Massachusetts at Buffalo	No pick (both): William Watson III (ankle) questionable, missed last game; Aedan McCarthy started it			
Sat 10.17.2026 10:00 AM	The Citadel at Texas A&M	No pick (both): not enough play-by-play this season: The Citadel			

Kickoff	Game	Engine (official)	Framework	Framework score	
Sat 10.17.2026 10:30 AM	Western Michigan at Central Michigan	Western Michigan 52%	Western Michigan 59%	Western Michigan 28 - Central Michigan 24	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 12:30 PM	Akron at Miami (OH)	No pick (both): David McComb (upper body) out for the season (MAC availability report); Caleb Heavner has 2 starts			
Sat 10.17.2026 12:30 PM	Alabama at Tennessee	No pick (both): Faizon Brandon (shoulder) questionable; George MacIntyre named to start a 2nd straight game while Brandon is hurt			
Sat 10.17.2026 12:30 PM	Arizona State at Texas Tech	**Texas Tech 81%**	Texas Tech 61%	Texas Tech 28 - Arizona State 24	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 12:30 PM	Auburn at Georgia	**Georgia 92%**	**Georgia 88%**	Georgia 37 - Auburn 18	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 12:30 PM	Georgia Tech at Virginia Tech	**Virginia Tech 83%**	**Virginia Tech 85%**	Virginia Tech 37 - Georgia Tech 20	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 12:30 PM	Missouri at Ole Miss	Ole Miss 55%	Missouri 62%	Missouri 30 - Ole Miss 25	**Split**
Sat 10.17.2026 12:30 PM	North Carolina at Duke	North Carolina 58%	Duke 66%	Duke 31 - North Carolina 25	**Split**
Sat 10.17.2026 12:30 PM	Northern Illinois at Wyoming	Wyoming 56%	**Wyoming 70%**	Wyoming 32 - Northern Illinois 23	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 12:30 PM	Penn State at Michigan	Michigan 65%	Michigan 64%	Michigan 29 - Penn State 24	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 12:30 PM	Toledo at Eastern Michigan	Toledo 67%	**Toledo 75%**	Toledo 32 - Eastern Michigan 21	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 12:30 PM	UNLV at Air Force	No pick (both): Liam Szarka (leg) out for the season; Kemper Hodges has 1 start			
Sat 10.17.2026 1:30 PM	Tulsa at Rice	Tulsa 53%	**Tulsa 71%**	Tulsa 30 - Rice 21	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 2:00 PM	Troy at Louisiana	Troy 51%	Troy 50%	Troy 28 - Louisiana 27	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 3:00 PM	Washington State at Oregon State	**Oregon State 91%**	**Oregon State 90%**	Oregon State 37 - Washington State 16	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 4:00 PM	Arkansas at Vanderbilt	Vanderbilt 64%	Vanderbilt 69%	Vanderbilt 31 - Arkansas 24	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 4:00 PM	Arkansas State at Southern Miss	Arkansas State 53%	Southern Miss 53%	Southern Miss 30 - Arkansas State 29	**Split**

Kickoff	Game	Engine (official)	Framework	Framework score	
Sat 10.17.2026 4:00 PM	Florida State at Miami	**Miami 91%**	**Miami 92%**	Miami 44 - Florida State 20	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 4:00 PM	Kent State at South Florida	**South Florida 86%**	**South Florida 70%**	South Florida 32 - Kent State 24	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 4:00 PM	Nevada at North Dakota State	No pick (both): Carter Jones (undisclosed) questionable (Oct 15)			
Sat 10.17.2026 4:00 PM	TCU at Baylor	Baylor 64%	**Baylor 75%**	Baylor 30 - TCU 19	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 4:30 PM	Elon at Stanford	No pick (both): not enough play-by-play this season: Elon			
Sat 10.17.2026 4:30 PM	Kentucky at Oklahoma	Oklahoma 65%	Oklahoma 56%	Oklahoma 25 - Kentucky 23	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 4:30 PM	Louisville at Syracuse	No pick (both): Starter not named: Amari Odom out, Steve Angeli and Malachi Nelson questionable (ACC report, Oct 15)			
Sat 10.17.2026 4:30 PM	Notre Dame at BYU	Notre Dame 60%	Notre Dame 52%	Notre Dame 28 - BYU 27	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 4:30 PM	Oklahoma State at Houston	**Houston 81%**	Houston 68%	Houston 33 - Oklahoma State 26	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 4:30 PM	Wisconsin at UCLA	**UCLA 71%**	UCLA 66%	UCLA 27 - Wisconsin 21	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 5:00 PM	Louisiana Tech at UL Monroe	**Louisiana Tech 73%**	**Louisiana Tech 76%**	Louisiana Tech 36 - UL Monroe 25	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 5:00 PM	Navy at UTSA	UTSA 64%	UTSA 67%	UTSA 33 - Navy 26	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 6:00 PM	San José State at UTEP	No pick (both): EJ Colson Jr. (concussion) questionable; Raymond Moore III started the last game			
Sat 10.17.2026 7:00 PM	Ohio at Sacramento State	Ohio 63%	**Ohio 71%**	Ohio 31 - Sacramento State 22	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 7:15 PM	Utah at Colorado	**Utah 78%**	**Utah 84%**	Utah 35 - Colorado 18	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 7:30 PM	Fresno State at San Diego State	Fresno State 59%	**Fresno State 79%**	Fresno State 32 - San Diego State 19	Agree
Sat 10.17.2026 7:30 PM	New Mexico at Hawai'i	**New Mexico 88%**	**New Mexico 86%**	New Mexico 33 - Hawai'i 15	Agree

Kickoff	Game	Engine (official)	Framework	Framework score
Sat 10.17.2026 7:30 PM	Wake Forest at California	No pick (both): Jaron-Keawe Sagapolutele (concussion) questionable; Jackson Brousseau started the last 2		
Sat 10.17.2026 8:00 PM	Nebraska at Oregon	No pick (both): Dante Moore (concussion) out again; Dylan Raiola was benched vs UCLA and Dan Lanning calls it a competition; starter not named		

They agree on 28 of 35 picks (green) and split on 7 (amber). Bold = 70%+. Grey = no pick. No pick: the starting QB is out or unconfirmed, or a team lacks enough play-by-play this season.

How far to trust them (college, same games). 2025: 580 games, engine 70.9%, framework 67.9%; 2026: 142 games, engine 67.6%, framework 65.5%.

Engine: the locked college method (NFL: with the approved NFL settings), rating every offense and defense on EPA and success rate, adjusted for opponents. Framework: your Prompt Football criteria (trenches 25%, net efficiency 25%, passing 20%, situational 15%, high leverage 15%) scored from this season's play-by-play only. Files: results/ in the sports-engines repo. Report made 10.17.2026 12:57 AM Phoenix time.